

got the corner suite with bay views in two directions, high luxury. In the 1950's, Mills Tower was one of the city's two tallest office buildings, along with the Russ Building. When he moved in 1970 to suite 1820, the view to the bay out both windows in both directions was clear. By the mid-1980's when I moved him out, he could see nothing but the taller office buildings across the street in any direction at all. Tied to the San Francisco office building boom of the 1970's, the city just grew up around him—and with the lack of bay view, much of his passion for being there faded.

Each night, he walked the mile back to the train station and read more on the way home, although late in his life, as said earlier, he fell asleep a lot on the train in the afternoon. He was in the office at 9:00 and left at 4:00 to return home. When it rained, he took the bus and hated it. The bus put him in close contact with all kinds of street people—after all, anyone can get on the bus—and even with the best of folks (and he wasn't a people person), he felt uncomfortable there. Compared to most business successes, he never worked very long hours or all that hard or frantically. Early on, I marveled at how someone could have succeeded as well as he did working as few hours as he did or with as little strenuous effort as he exerted; but it was because of his genius. At times, he was like a laser beam and beautiful to behold. You only need a relative few of those times in a career to accomplish a great deal if you don't screw up too badly at other times. He had the one and not the other, and that made it work.

And he was always alone. Until my brother went to work with him in 1970, he never had more than a part-time secretary around him, several half-days a week. For decades, up until the early 1970's (which also marked the beginning of his business decline), it was one woman, Mrs. Del Poso. As a young man, I never got to know her in any real way at all, which I now regret because I'm sure I could have learned lots about Father from her. Otherwise he was solitary. Non-social. Thinking. Reading. Talking on the phone, yes, but not oriented toward being with people. A very definite non-people person.

Father loved to watch election returns. Always. A passion. He had a marvelous memory before dementia. Routinely, he memorized the names of all 435 members of the House of Representatives and the 100 senators. To put himself to sleep at night, he would go state by state through their names until he drifted off. He also memorized each state capital and made me do it